Quietly

Module 1: Foundational — Marketing 101

B2B & Stakeholder Archetypes

Module 1: Chapters

01 **Marketing Disciplines - An Overview**

Understanding various marketing functions, and how they all fit together.

02 **The Connective Tissue**

How content strategy acts as the "dark matter" or connective tissue between disparate marketing departments.

03 **B2B & Stakeholder Archetypes**

Identifying what different functions care about throughout the customer lifecycle.

04 **How Other Agencies Do It**

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In this chapter...



Overview

This chapter examines the B2B organizational landscape where various teams optimize different stages of the customer lifecycle, prioritizing unique metrics and content. By understanding the B2B stakeholder archetypes, you will see how content acts as a critical, unifying force that requires alignment to ensure a cohesive, end-to-end customer journey.

Time required to complete this chapter: 15 mins

Outcomes

What you should know coming out of it:

- How B2B functions optimize different customer lifecycle stages
- What each team prioritizes when it comes to content and unique metrics
- Explain how content serves a critical, unifying role across the B2B ecosystem

To consider as you step through this chapter...

- What does ‘content’ mean and/or how does it come to life across different teams, LoBs and functions across an organization?
- In what ways is the role of content expanding beyond traditional Marketing and Communications to influence broader organizational functions?
- How does content strategy serve as the "connective tissue" or "dark matter" that bridges gaps between disparate marketing disciplines?

Heads up

You will be taking a 5 minute multiple choice quiz at the end of this chapter. Be sure to take notes as you progress.

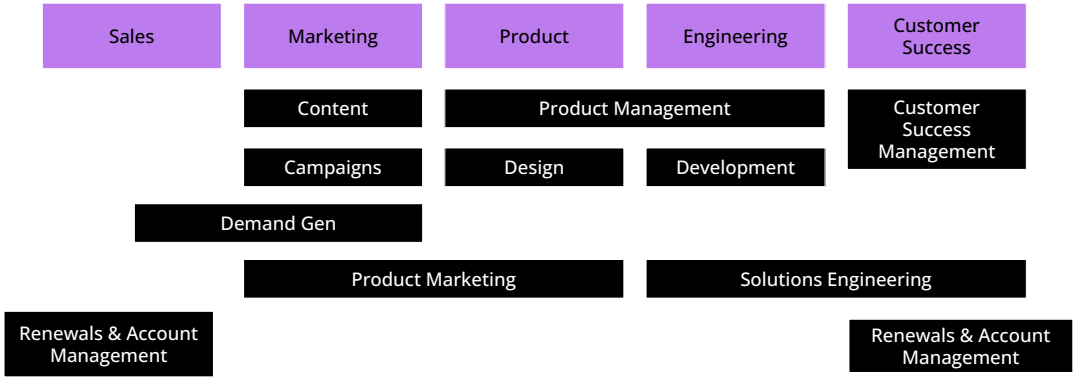
Now, let's get into it...

B2B organizational landscape

In a B2B organization, marketing and revenue functions are highly interconnected, but **each team is responsible for optimizing a different stage of the customer lifecycle**—from generating awareness to driving retention and growth. As a result, they each prioritize different metrics, insights, and types of content based on their role in moving the customer forward.

No matter the function, every team should have a **growth mindset.**

Common B2B org structure

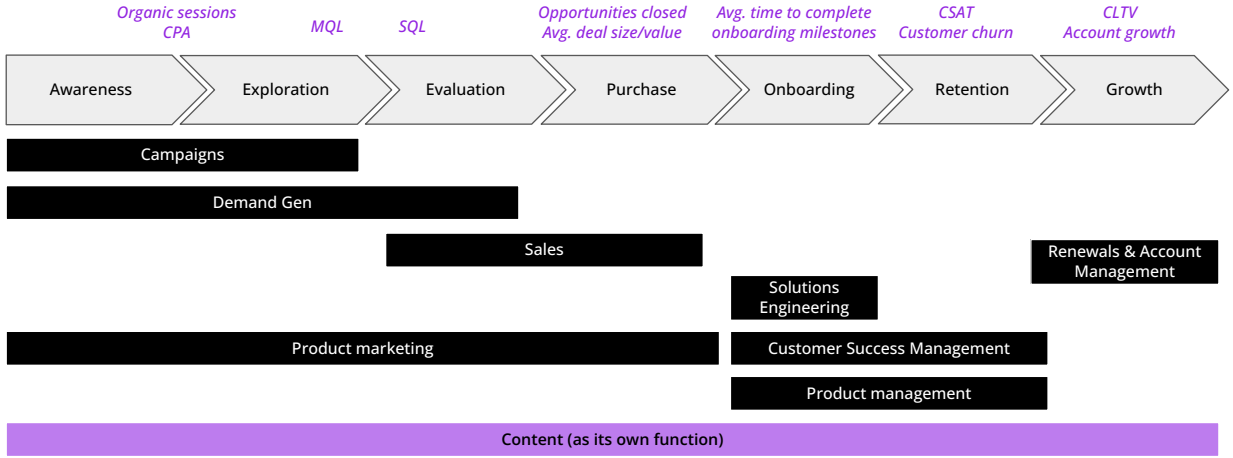


Content sits in the middle of it all

Content plays a critical unifying role across this ecosystem: while Demand Gen may focus on conversion assets, Sales on proof points, and Customer Success on onboarding and education, all rely on tailored content to achieve their goals.

The challenge—and opportunity—is ensuring content is aligned across these functions to support a cohesive, end-to-end customer journey.

What does each function care about?



What does each team care about?

Now that we've established the organizational structure, let's double click into each 'B2B stakeholder Archetype' to understand the insights and content that are priorities for each.

Each function optimizes for a different part of the customer journey — but all rely on shared insights and content to succeed.

B2B archetypes

B2B Archetype/team	Key functions	Journey stage focus & goals	Prioritized insights & content
CAMPAIGNS	• Executes integrated marketing campaigns across channels to drive awareness and engagement • Orchestrates messaging and timing across teams and touchpoints	Awareness → Exploration (reach, engagement, campaign performance)	• Channel performance, campaign analytics (e.g. CPA, organic sessions) • Campaign messaging, creative assets, and audience segmentation
DEMAND GENERATION	• Drives pipeline creation through acquisition strategies and conversion tactics • Focuses on turning audience interest into qualified leads	Exploration → Evaluation (MQLs, cost efficiency)	• Conversion data (MQLs, CPA, funnel performance) • Gated content, landing pages, performance-driven assets
CONTENT (MARKETING SUBSET)	• Develops content that supports all stages of the customer journey • Acts as the connective layer across teams and lifecycle stages	Full lifecycle (supports Awareness → Growth)	• Audience insights, search trends, engagement data • Scalable content formats (editorial, thought leadership, enablement)
PRODUCT MARKETING	• Owns positioning, messaging, and go-to-market narratives • Translates product features into customer value	Exploration → Evaluation (education, differentiation)	• Competitive intelligence, market trends • Messaging frameworks, use cases, solution storytelling

B2B archetypes con't

B2B Archetype/team	Key functions	Journey stage focus & goals	Prioritized insights & content
PRODUCT MANAGEMENT	• Defines product roadmap, features, and long-term vision • Aligns product development with market needs	Evaluation → Growth (product-market fit, adoption)	• Customer feedback, usage data, market needs • Feature adoption insights, roadmap validation inputs
SALES	• Converts leads into revenue through direct customer engagement • Manages deal cycles, objections, and negotiations	Evaluation → Purchase (closing opportunities)	• Opportunities closed, deal size/value, SQLs • Case studies, ROI proof, competitive comparisons
SOLUTIONS ENGINEERING	• Provides technical validation and product expertise during the sales process • Bridges product capabilities with customer requirements	Evaluation → Purchase (technical validation)	• Product specs, integrations, technical documentation • Demo environments, solution architectures
CUSTOMER SUCCESS MANAGEMENT	• Ensures customers achieve value after purchase • Drives onboarding, satisfaction, and retention	Onboarding → Retention (time-to-value, CSAT)	• Onboarding milestones, CSAT, usage insights • Educational content, onboarding guides, best practices
RENEWALS & ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT	• Focuses on retaining and growing existing accounts • Drives renewals, upsells, and long-term account value	Retention → Growth (CLTV, account expansion)	• Customer health data, churn risk, account performance • Expansion opportunities, value-driven content, ROI reporting

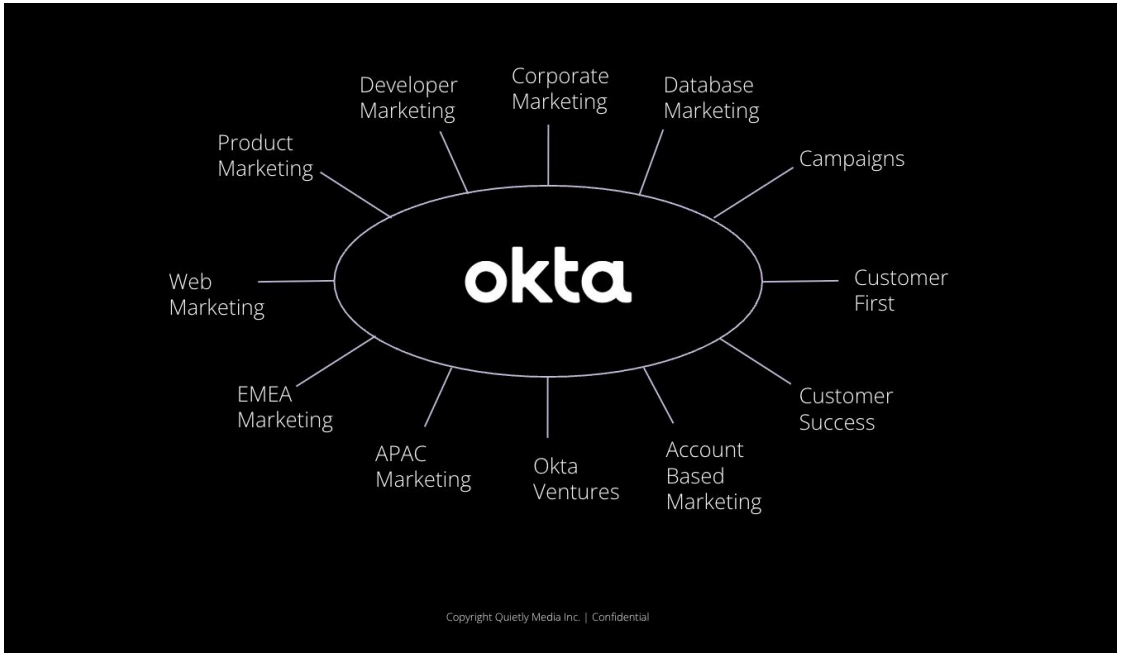
Case study: Okta's content needs

Working with various Okta teams, we saw overlap in topics, audiences, and channels, but efforts weren't always aligned strategically and operationally.

As their content hub, we increased visibility and alignment, identified content efficiencies, and combined efforts for greater content ROI.

Formalizing content as an organizational function beyond Marketing enabled effective scaling.

Example: Synchronizing content across teams and audiences



Key takeaways

Tying it all together...

- Content is a critical, unifying force, existing throughout the B2B organizational landscape where each function optimizes a different stage of the customer lifecycle.
- Strategic alignment of content across all functions is necessary to ensure a cohesive, end-to-end customer journey, often requiring content to be formalized beyond Marketing.
- Understanding B2B stakeholder archetypes reveals the specific metrics, insights, and tailored content priorities for each team to succeed.

Applying this to your day-to-day

Considerations for cross-functional collaboration:

Client Partners

- Understand the different stakeholder groups within the organization and what they care about, as this can be an avenue to account growth (outside of our Marketing stakeholders)

Strategists

- Develop and champion an Enterprise content strategy that formalizes content beyond Marketing, ensuring alignment across all B2B functions to support a cohesive, end-to-end customer journey.

Content & Creative Teams

- Produce content that serves each B2B archetype's needs as it relates to the journey stages and accompanying customer mindsets they care about most.

Quiz time!

Details about how long, etc.

Click here.

Up next...

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